UCLA Graduate STUDENT ASSOCIATION

Resolution for Four Year Housing Guarantee at the University of California, Los Angeles

WHEREAS, it is the responsibility of the Associated Students of UC Los Angeles, hereafter named ASUCLA, "to advocate for [UC Los Angeles] students within the University, the community, the state, and the nation," and the duty of the Senate of ASUCLA to "represent the interests and opinions of UC Los Angeles graduate students";[1] and

WHEREAS, it is the mission of ASUCLA to facilitate and encourage all students to grow and develop through their involvement in student government, its services and auxiliaries and to promote student engagement in all areas of campus life through leadership, advocacy, and service in order to build and strengthen the community;[2] and

WHEREAS, with its vision to encourage a future with new and innovative ideas to improve the community and approach problems, ASUCLA will advocate for the most basic of needs including housing through active collaboration and communication with students and administration; and

WHEREAS, in January 2016, UC President Janet Napolitano announced a housing initiative aimed at supporting current students and future enrollment growth across the UC system, with the goal of ensuring that each campus has sufficient housing for its growing student population;[3] and

WHEREAS, ASUCLA is aware that housing is an integral part of the student experience and students who live on campus benefit both academically and socially; and

WHEREAS, on-campus students were more engaged—that is, they devoted more time and effort to studies and other learning activities—in their place of residence;[4] and

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[1]AS University of California Los Angeles, https://www.asucla.ucla.edu/governements
[2]AS University of California Los Angeles, https://www.asucla.ucla.edu/about-asucla
[3]"The University of California's next Phase of Improving Student Basic Needs," https://regents.universityofcalifornia.edu/regmeet/nov20/s1attach.pdf
[4]"The Case for Campus Housing: Results from a National Study - ACUHO-I," https://www.acuho-i.org/Portals/0/doc/Case-Campus-Housing_Students-Parents-Media.pdf

WHEREAS, an unmet demand for on campus student housing and a rise in off campus housing market prices force students to face housing insecurity in which they face adverse effects on their academic performance and mental health wellbeing; [5] and

WHEREAS, the lack of on campus housing investment and infrastructure provides an insurmountable financial burden to all students as Westwood is one of the most expensive locations in the state of California for renters;[6] and

WHEREAS, 4-year guaranteed housing has been established for undergraduates at UCLA as of fall 2022, excluding graduate and professional students, who make up one-third of UCLA's student body, without a plan to assure housing security for them; [7] and

WHEREAS, additional on graduate campus housing with a guarantee to live on campus can help address the increase of 12,748 in graduate student enrollment within the UC system observed between 2012-2022 and address ongoing housing insecurity amongst the graduate and professional student population;[6] and be it further

RESOLVED, ASUCLA calls on UC Los Angeles to continue its advocacy efforts to secure additional on campus housing funding from the California State Legislature to meet the demand for on campus student housing; and be it further

RESOLVED, ASUCLA calls on the University of California Board of Regents and UC President Michael V. Drake to expand its funding support for on campus housing within the UC system to ensure all students do not face housing insecurity and that 4-year housing commitments can be guaranteed to all campuses; and be it further

RESOLVED, ASUCLA calls on the University of California Board of Regents and UC President Michael V. Drake to guarantee fiscal contributions to and publicize a timeline for an affordable 4-year housing guarantee to all University of California.

RESOLVED, that a copy of this resolution be distributed to California State Legislature, California Governor Gavin Newsom, UC Los Angeles Chancellor Gene Block, UC Los Angeles Vice Chancellor for Student Affairs Monroe Gorden Jr., UC Los Angeles Assistant Vice Chancellor for Student Affairs Michelle Ventura, UC Los Angeles Assistant Vice Chancellor for Housing and Hospitality Services Peter Angelis, UC Student Association President, UC President Michael V. Drake, UC Regents Chair, UC Council of Presidents.

The sponsors of this resolution are Amaka Enueme, Director of Internal Affairs of the Graduate Student Association and Noor Nakhaei, President of the Graduate Student Association.

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[5] "UC housing crisis forces students into multiple jobs to pay rent, sleeping bags and stress," https://www.latimes.com/california/story/2022-09-26/college-housing-shortage-pushes-students-into-crisis-as-most-uc-classes-start-up

"UC historical Fall Enrollment, 1869 to Present", https://www.universityofcalifornia.edu/about-us/information-center/historical-enrollment

[6]Flemming Jack, “Westwood Is Once Again California’s Priciest Spot For Renters, Study Finds”, https://www.latimes.com/business/real-estate/story/2019-10-09/westwood-california
[7]Person and Hans Johnson, “Enrollment Increases Will Require More Housing for UC and CSU Students,” Public Policy Institute of California (Public Policy Institute of California, August 22, 2022), https://www.ppic.org/blog/enrollment-increases-will-require-more-housing-for-uc-and-csu-students
[8]UCLA Daily Bruin, https://dailybruin.com/2022/04/13/editorial-uclas-historic-housing-guarantee-needs-to-be-extended-to-graduate-students